



BNP Paribas

BNP Paribas (French pronunciation: [bɛ̃npe paʁiba]; sometimes referred to as **BNPP** or **BNP**) is a French multinational universal bank and financial services holding company headquartered in Paris.^{[5][6][7][8]} It was founded in 2000 from the merger of two of France's foremost financial institutions, Banque Nationale de Paris (BNP) and Paribas.^[9] It also incorporates many other major institutions through successive acquisitions, including Fortis Bank in Belgium, Direkt Anlage Bank in Germany, Banca Nazionale del Lavoro in Italy, Banque Générale du Luxembourg in Luxembourg, and Türk Ekonomi Bankası in Turkey. The group has also been present in the United States through its subsidiaries Bank of the West until 2023 and First Hawaiian Bank until 2019. With 190,000 employees, the bank is organized into three major business areas: Commercial, Personal Banking & Services (CPBS); Investment & Protection Services (IPS); and Corporate & Institutional Banking (CIB).

BNP Paribas is listed on Euronext Paris and is a component of the Euro Stoxx 50 stock market index.^[10] It is the second largest bank in Europe and eighth largest bank in the world by total assets.^[11] It became one of the five largest banks in the world following the 2007–2008 financial crisis.^[12] It is considered a systemically important bank by the Financial Stability Board.^[13] In the Forbes Global 2000, BNP Paribas was ranked as the 33rd largest public company in the world.^[14] It has been designated as a Significant Institution since the entry into force of European Banking Supervision in late 2014, and as a consequence is directly supervised by the European Central Bank.^{[15][16]}

Although a French banking group, the Belgian government has been a significant shareholder since 2009 (with 5.3% equity ownership as of mid-2023)^[17] as a result of the group's acquisition of *Fortis Bank Belgium*, heir to the Société Générale de Belgique established in 1822.^[18]

History

In 1999, BNP and Société Générale fought a complex battle on the stock market, with Société Générale bidding for Paribas and BNP bidding for Société Générale and counter-bidding for Paribas. BNP's bid for Société Générale failed, while its bid for Paribas succeeded leading to a merger of BNP and Paribas one year later on 23 May 2000.

In 2006, BNP Paribas purchased Banca Nazionale del Lavoro (BNL), Italy's sixth-largest bank. On 9 August 2007, BNP Paribas became the first major financial group to acknowledge the impact of the sub-prime

BNP Paribas



The headquarters of BNP Paribas in Paris

Company type	Public
Traded as	Euronext Paris: BNP (https://euronext.com/products/equities/FR0000131104-XPAP) LSE: OHB5 (https://www.londonstockexchange.com/stock/OHB5/) CAC 40 component (BNP)
Industry	<u>Financial services</u>
Founded	13 December 1822 Creation of <u>Société Générale de Belgique</u>, predecessor of <u>Fortis Bank</u> 10 March 1848^[1] creation of <u>Comptoir national d'escompte de Paris</u>, predecessor of BNP 27 January 1872^[2] creation of <u>Banque de Paris et des Pays-Bas</u>, later called Paribas 23 May 2000^[3] merging as BNP Paribas
Headquarters	<u>20 Boulevard des Italiens</u> Paris, France
Area served	Worldwide
Key people	<u>Jean Lemierre</u> (Chairman) <u>Jean-Laurent Bonnafé</u> (CEO)
Products	<u>Asset management</u> <u>Banking</u> <u>Commodities</u>

crisis by closing two funds exposed to it. This day is now generally seen as the start of the [2007–2008 financial crisis](#) and the bank's quick reaction saved it from the fate of other large European banks such as [UBS](#).^{[19][20]}

On 6 October 2008, BNP took over 75% of troubled bank [Fortis](#)' activities in [Belgium](#), and 66% in [Luxembourg](#), in exchange for the Belgian government becoming the new group's major shareholder. The sales of the Fortis shares was suspended by a court order from the [Court of Appeal](#) on Friday, 12 December^{[21][22][23]} In the end of January, the Belgian government and BNP negotiated for a 75% partnership in Fortis Bank Belgium. Fortis Insurance Belgium would be reintegrated in Fortis Holding.^[24]

On 11 February, Fortis' shareholders decided that [Fortis Bank Belgium](#) and Fortis Insurance Belgium should not become the property of BNP Paribas. However, the acquisition was completed, and BNP Paribas took 75% shareholding and renamed the new subsidiary [BNP Paribas Fortis](#). After this only Fortis Insurance International was left in Fortis Holding and this was renamed as Ageas, a business that had Insurance all over Europe and Asia. In April 2024, it was announced BNP Paribas had acquired [Fosun International's](#) entire 9% stake in Ageas, worth €730 million.^[25] The remaining [Fortis Bank Netherlands](#) was in the hands of the [Dutch Government](#) which merged it with other ABN AMRO holdings it already owned under the name [ABN AMRO](#).

In May 2009, BNP Paribas became the majority shareholder (65.96%) of BGL (formerly Fortis Bank Luxembourg), the State of Luxembourg retaining 34% making BNP the [eurozone's](#) largest bank by deposits held.^[26] On 21 September, the bank's registered name was changed to [BGL BNP Paribas](#) and in February 2010, BGL BNP Paribas became the 100% owner of BNP Paribas Luxembourg. The transfer was finalised on 1 October 2010 with the incorporation of BNP Paribas Luxembourg's business in the operational platforms of BGL BNP Paribas.^[27] In 2013 BNP Paribas was awarded the Bank of the Year award by The International Financing Review ("IFR"), [Thomson Reuters'](#) leading financial industry publication.^{[28][29][30]}

BNP Paribas reached an agreement in December 2013 to acquire Rabobank's Polish unit BGZ Bank for around \$1.4 billion.^[31] In September 2014, BNP completed the purchase of BGZ Bank for a final fee stated in the media to be \$1.3 billion.^{[32][33][34]} In December 2021, BNP Paribas announced to exit US retail banking business by selling its Bank of the West to the Bank of Montreal for \$16.3bn.^[35]

BNP Paribas has around \$80 billion under management in Asia by 2024. The bank has hired 20 private bankers, including Tiffeny Situ from [Morgan Stanley](#), Wendy Chan from [Citigroup](#) and Martin Loh from [Credit Suisse Group](#), as part of its expansion program.^[36]

Financial data

In 2022, total revenues of €50.4 billion represent an increase of 9% compared to 2021, BNP Paribas remains at the top of the French banks' ranking in terms of activity. During this year, BNP Paribas Group net income attributable to equity holders increased to 7.5% (to 10.2 billion euros). The geographic breakdown of Net Banking Income (NBI) at the end of

[Credit cards](#)
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[Mortgage loans](#)
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[Risk management](#)
[Wealth management](#)

Revenue ▲ €45.9 billion (2023)^[4]

Operating income ▼ €11.2 billion (2023)^[4]

Net income ▲ €10.9 billion (2023)^[4]

Total assets ▼ €2.59 trillion (2023)^[4]

Total equity ▲ €124 billion (2023)^[4]

Number of employees 186,162 (2023)^[4]

Divisions

List

- [BNP Paribas Asset Management](#)
- [BNP Paribas Cardif](#)
- [BNP Paribas Factor](#)
- [BNP Paribas Fortis](#)
- [BNP Paribas Real Estate](#)

Subsidiaries

List

- [Arval](#)
- [Banca Nazionale del Lavoro](#)
- [Cetelem](#)
- [Hello bank!](#)

Website group.bnpparibas/en/ (<http://group.bnpparibas/en/>)



Former headquarters of [Banca Nazionale del Lavoro](#) in Rome

2020 is as follows: Europe (72.2%), North America (12.9%), Asia Pacific (8.6%) and others (6.3%).^[37]



BNP Paribas London Trading Floor



BNP Paribas locations

Financial data in € billions^[38]

Year	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022
Revenue	38.822	39.168	42.938	43.411	43.161	42.516	44.597	44.275	46.235	50.419
Net Income	5.439	0.507	7.044	8.115	8.207	7.526	8.173	7.067	9.488	10.196
Assets	1,800.139	2,077.759	1,994.193	2,076.959	1,960.252	2,041	2,165	2,488	2,634	2,666
Employees	185,000	188,000	189,000	192,000	196,000	203,000	199,000	193,000	190,000	190,000

Corporate identity

The BNP Paribas logo since 2000 (designed by Laurent Vincent under the leadership of the Communications Director, Antoine Sire) is called the "courbe d'envol" (curve of taking flight). The stars allude to Europe and universality. The transformation of the stars into birds conveys openness, freedom, growth, and the ability to change and adapt. The shape and movement of the curve places the logo in the universe of life. The green square symbolises nature and optimism.^[39]



Français : BNP Paribas logo

Corporate structure

Executive Committee

The General Management and the executive committee are composed as follows:

- Jean-Laurent Bonnafé, Director and chief executive officer of BNP Paribas
- Yann Gérardin, directeur général délégué, chief operating officer, Corporate & Institutional Banking
- Thierry Laborde, directeur général Délégué, chief operating officer, Retail Banking
- Laurent David, Deputy chief operating officer
- Renaud Dumora, Deputy chief operating officer, Investment & Protection Services
- Marguerite Bérard, Head of French Retail Banking
- Stefaan Decraene, Head of International Retail Banking
- Charlotte Dennery, Director and chief executive officer of BNP Paribas Personal Finance

- Bernard Gavgani, chief information officer
- Elena Goitini, chief executive officer of BNL
- Stephanie Maarek, Head of Compliance
- Max Jadot, CEO and chairman of the executive board of BNP Paribas Fortis.
- Yannick Jung, Head of Corporate & Institutional Banking Global Banking EMEA

Board of directors

As of 17 May 2021^[40]

- Jean Lemierre (chairman), former president of the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development
- Jean-Laurent Bonnafé, CEO of BNP Paribas
- Jacques Aschenbroich, chairman and CEO of Valeo
- Pierre-André de Chalendar, chairman and CEO of Saint-Gobain
- Monique Cohen, partner at Apax Partners
- Wouter De Ploey, CEO of ZNA
- Hugues Epailard, BNP Paribas Real Estate executive
- Rajna Gibson Brandon, professor at the University of Geneva
- Marion Guillou, global food security academic

Major shareholders

As of 31 December 2023^[41]

- European institutional investors (37.7%)
- Non-European institutional investors (32.5%)
- BlackRock Inc. (6.9%)
- Belgian State (through SFPI) (5.5%)
- Amundi (5.4%)
- Retail shareholders (5.9%)
- Employees (5.0%)
- Grand Duchy of Luxembourg (1.1%)

Main subsidiaries

Retail banking

- BNP Paribas France (more than 2 200 branches)
- BNP Paribas Bulgaria
- BancWest (Bank of the West in the USA)
- BNP Paribas El Djazaïr (Algeria)
- BMCI (Morocco)
- Banca Nazionale del Lavoro (BNL) (Italy)
- Türk Ekonomi Bankası (TEB) (Turkey, Kosovo)
- BNP Paribas Fortis (Belgium, Germany, Poland, Turkey)
- BGL BNP Paribas (Luxembourg)
- Hello bank!
- Sahara Bank (Libya)
- Ukrsibbank (Ukraine)
- BCI Mer Rouge Djibouti



Design BNP Paribas par Laurent Vincenti pour A&Co



Jean Lemierre, Senior Adviser to the chairman, BNP Paribas Group, France, at the World Economic Forum on Europe and Central Asia in Istanbul, 30 October - 1 November 2008

- Banque de Wallis et Futuna
- BNP Paribas Bank Polska (Poland)

Other subsidiaries

- Alfred Berg
- BNP Paribas Arbitrage
- BNP Paribas Assurances with Cardif, Pinnacle
- BNP Paribas Investment Partners
- BNP Paribas Partners for Innovation
- BNP Paribas Personal Finance UK (Creation Financial Services Limited and Creation Consumer Finance Limited)^[42]
- BNP Paribas Primebrokerag
- BNP Paribas Real Estate (formerly Atisreal)
- BNP Paribas Leasing Solutions^[43] with Arval,^[44] and Artegy
- BNP Paribas Securities Services
- BNP Paribas Wealth Management
- Cetelem
- Consors Finanz
- Cortal Consors
- FundQuest
- SBI Life Insurance Company Limited a joint venture insurance company with State Bank of India, India's largest financial service company
- Sharekhan, an Indian retail brokerage firm
- L'Atelier BNP Paribas
- BNP Paribas Personal Investors Luxembourg^[45]
- Protection 24^{[46][47]}
- SAIB-BNP Paribas Asset Management^[48]

Divisions

BNP Paribas CIB

BNP Paribas CIB (Corporate and Institutional Banking) is the global investment banking arm of BNP Paribas, the largest banking group in the world. In October 2010, BNP Paribas was ranked by Bloomberg and Forbes as the largest bank and largest company in the world by assets with over US\$3.1 trillion.^{[51][52]}

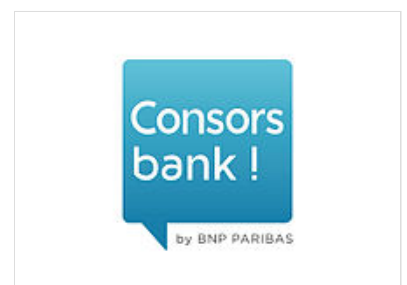
BNP Paribas CIB's main centres are in Paris and London, with large scale operations in New York, Hong Kong, and Singapore, and smaller operations in almost every financial centre in the world. It employs 185,000 people across 56 countries and provides financing, advisory and capital markets services. BNP Paribas CIB is a globally recognised leader in two areas of expertise: trading derivatives on all asset classes, and structured financing.^[49] BNP Paribas CIB also has a large corporate advisory network in Europe and Asia. BNP Paribas CIB has 13,000 clients, consisting of companies, financial institutions, governments, investment funds and hedge funds.



Italian Headquarters in Milan



Orizzonte Europa, BNL
Headquarters in Rome subsidiary of BNP Paribas



Consorsbank



Sharekhan after acquisition by BNP Paribas

BNP Paribas CIB



BNP Paribas CIB benefits from the Group's large asset base (over €2 trillion) and diverse business model, and was resilient through the 2007–2008 financial crisis.^[49] Revenues from BNP Paribas CIB nearly doubled in the second quarter of 2009 as robust investor demand boosted revenues from the bank's fixed income trading business unit. CIB's revenues totaled €3.351 billion (US\$4.82 billion) for the quarter, up 81 percent from the second quarter of 2008, and following record revenues of €3.696 billion in the first quarter of 2009.^[53]



The Maison dorée, home to Parisian operations of BNP Paribas CIB, with the registered office of BNP Paribas in the background

Notable current and former employees

Business

- Nassim Taleb – Practitioner of financial mathematics, author of *The Black Swan*, *Fooled by Randomness* and *Dynamic Hedging*, and former BNP Paribas prop trader in New York City.

Politics and public service

- Louis Alphonse of Bourbon, Duke of Anjou - considered by royalists as the head of the French Royal House.
- Jacques de Larosière - managing director of the International Monetary Fund (1978–87); Governor of the Banque de France (1987–93)
- Lorenz of Habsburg, Archduke of Austria-Este
- François Villeroy de Galhau, Governor of the Bank of France since 2015

Other

- David McWilliams - economist

Controversies

Antisemitic allegations

In 2016 BNP reached an undisclosed settlement^[54] with a Jewish employee, following a \$40M lawsuit.^[55] The employee had been made to watch a training video in the form of a parody of the movie *Downfall*^[56], portraying Adolf Hitler as the CEO of Deutsche Bank, one of BNP's competitors and the Nazi soldiers around him as Deutsche Bank executives. Also, his colleagues made a number of anti-semitic comments during his time at BNP Paribas.^[57]

Business with sanctioned countries

On 30 May 2014, *The Wall Street Journal* reported that the United States Department of Justice was negotiating a possible guilty plea with BNP Paribas as well as the size of the resulting fine for violating U.S. regulations and evading US sanctions. The Justice Department sought a fine of more than US \$10 billion, which was expected to be reduced to \$8 or \$9 billion in negotiations.^[58] BNP Paribas was said to have laundered up to US\$100 billion from the sanctioned countries of Sudan, Iran, and Cuba.^[59]

Company type	Subsidiary of BNP Paribas
Industry	Financial services
Founded	23 May 2000
Headquarters	Paris , France
Products	Corporate banking Investment banking
Revenue	US\$27.6 billion (2008) ^[49]
Net income	10,975,000,000 Euro (2023)
Total assets	€3.1 trillion (2010)
Number of employees	17,000 (2007) ^[50]
Website	cib.bnpparibas.com (http://cib.bnpparibas.com)

On 1 July 2014, BNP Paribas pled guilty in a New York state court to falsifying business records as well as conspiracy in connection to those falsifications. It was also expected to plead guilty in federal court to violating laws against money-laundering.^[60] It agreed to pay \$8.9 billion, the largest fine ever for violating U.S. sanctions, and substantially more than the previous record of \$1.9 billion.^{[33][60]} BNP Paribas was also barred for one year under the plea agreement from certain US dollar-dominated transactions. The fine exceeded the bank's \$6.4 billion 2013 annual income and the \$1.1 billion it previously had allocated for the anticipated fine.^{[60][61]}

The bank's failure to cooperate with the multi-year investigation was given as a significant factor in the size of the fine. Additionally, BNP Paribas continued to process sanctioned transactions after the investigation began.^{[60][62]} After the fine was announced, BNP said it would be "just fine" and that it had "a comprehensive plan" to avoid similar violations in the future. The company's stock, which had fallen 12% since news of the investigation first leaked, rose 4% on the announcement.^{[60][61]} To comply with the transaction ban, BNP Paribas will use a third party to clear its US transactions.^[63]

On 6 February 2024, the Federal Reserve announced that it had lifted a pair of 2014 enforcement actions it imposed on France's BNP Paribas, after the bank overhauled its compliance with U.S. sanctions laws.^[1] (<https://www.reuters.com/business/finance/fed-terminates-2014-enforcement-actions-against-frances-bnp-sanctions-issues-2024-02-06/>)

Check processing

In 2010 the French government's Autorité de la concurrence fined BNP and 10 other banks €384 million for colluding to charge unjustified fees on check processing, including extra fees during the transition from paper check transfer to "Exchanges Check-Image" electronic transfer.^{[64][65]}

€152 million risk management affair

The German *Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung*^[66] FOCUS,^[67] Bloomberg^[68] and the French *Les Échos*^[69] newspapers published an article regarding a €152 million mistrade (erroneous trade) in which BNP Paribas Arbitrage was allegedly involved.^{[70][71]} The bank has sold securities for €326,400 to the investor Armin S. but the value of the securities is €163 million according to the bank. According to the article, the error remained unnoticed for several days. BNP has even reconfirmed the original price.^{[72][73][74]}

The *Financial Times* published an article in March 2018 about the case with the title "BNP Paribas failed to book trades in Germany for a week". It cites internal documents that show it did not book all trades that happened in structured products in Germany from 2 to 9 December 2015. The *Financial Times* estimates that 8,500 trades might have been affected. It also questions if the bank has hedged their positions if the trades have not been booked.^{[75][76][77]}

Sponsorship

BNP Paribas has been a major sponsor of tennis. In 1973 it became the major sponsor of the French Open, one of the four prestigious Grand Slam tournaments in the sport. In 2001 the bank began to sponsor the Davis Cup before becoming the title sponsor in 2002. In 2002 it became the sponsor of the Paris Masters, an ATP World Tour Masters 1000 tournament.

In 2008 it became the sponsor of the BNP Paribas Primrose Bordeaux, an ATP Challenger Tour tournament. The company's sponsorship expanded to the United States in 2009 when it became the title sponsor of the Indian Wells Masters, an ATP World Tour Masters 1000 two-week tournament in California. It also sponsored the BNP Paribas Showdown and BNP Paribas Tennis Classic exhibition tournaments held in New York City and London respectively. The Stanford Classic, since 1992, is instead directly sponsored by the Bank of the West subsidiary.



2011 Davis Cup in Zagreb